

World Wide Web

Is the novelist, or the poet in you suffocated? Give them all the literary space they need, online!

One are the days, when to publish his or her work, a writer, a poet or a journalist, had to be dependent upon print media. With the Internet affecting all aspects of our life, online publishing has become an important part of the media. The reasons are quite obvious. Just think about the effort, money and time required if you wanted to publish a story that you have written. You've got to prepare a manuscript, make copies of it and send it to numerous publishers. And then, depending upon the publisher's evaluation of your work, it may, or may not be published.

With online publishing, you can send your work to a number of publishers, the world, over, in a very short time at low costs. Even if your work is not published anywhere, you can always publish your

work on your own Web site or sites specific to your musing. Further, the reach of the Internet is far better than the print media, enabling your work to get a wide, yet targetted audience.

If you are an amateur writer, there are Web sites where you could publish your work, get feedback and improve your writing. A seasoned writer will have the benefit of more people reading his or her work. If

you are a researcher, you can get your papers read by experts throughout the world. Online publishing basically involves online newspapers, magazines, journals and e-books. Some of these talk about general topics, while others are very specific in terms of the matter they cover.

General writing

Apart from regular print magazines, there are many journals and magazines that are published online. These magazines do not come with a subscription fee, neither do they charge anything to include articles—in fact, some even pay the writers. The number of such Web sites is huge and they can be very general, covering almost all subjects such as ArticleCity.com (www.articlecity.com), to ones such as Story Bites (www.storybytes.com) that publish

stories strictly based on their word count.

There are many e-zines, that have only an online presence such as Sulekha (www.sulekha.com), and Freshlime Soda (www.freshlimesoda.com). Sulekha is an e-zine for Indians across the world. Apart from the regular articles, three new articles contributed by readers are published everyday. You can contribute to the columns, news stories, e-cards, photo album, art, reviews, information on events, Indian baby names and Coffeehouse sections of the e-zines. If you think that you can write a script for an Indian movie, then Write Angle (www.sulekha.com/b4u/) is opportunity knocking at your door. Write Angle is a joint venture between Sulekha and B4U—the music channel, which is being launched with a global contest of great movie story ideas. The winner of this contest will win Rs 2 lakhs and a globally telecast interview among other prizes. This contest is held yearly. Sulekha has also entered the print media with Sulekha Select, which is a collection of selected writings taken from nearly 1,200 writings published on the Web site since 1998.

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MouthShut.com (www.mouthshut.com) is India's first and largest, peer-to-peer information exchange portal. Here, you can write your opinion on thousands of products and services that are manufactured and sold in India. Thus, it provides critical data to manufacturers to improve customer satisfaction, marketing strategies



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